

# Business Summary Report

Task 2 — Advanced Data Analysis, SQL Joins & Business KPI Dashboard

Superstore Sales Dataset | 9,994 Order Lines | 5,009 Orders | 793 Customers | Maincrafts Technology

\$2,297,201  
TOTAL SALES

\$286,397  
TOTAL PROFIT

12.47%  
PROFIT MARGIN

793  
TOTAL CUSTOMERS

\$458.61  
AVG ORDER VALUE

This report presents the Task 2 business performance analysis, combining the Orders and Customers datasets via SQL JOIN, calculating key business KPIs, and analysing performance across region, product category, customer segment, and time. The dataset covers 9,994 order line items, 5,009 unique orders, and 793 unique customers.

## 1. KPI Overview & Regional Performance

| Region  | Sales     | Profit    | Margin | Share |
|---------|-----------|-----------|--------|-------|
| West ★  | \$725,458 | \$108,418 | 14.94% | 31.6% |
| East    | \$678,781 | \$91,523  | 13.48% | 29.6% |
| Central | \$501,240 | \$39,706  | 7.92%  | 21.8% |
| South   | \$391,722 | \$46,749  | 11.93% | 17.1% |

West generates the highest revenue at \$725,458 (31.6% of total sales) with \$108,418 profit and the best margin among the top two regions at 14.94%. **Central is the weakest region** — \$501,240 in sales but only a 7.92% margin, the lowest of all four regions, signalling excessive discounting or higher fulfilment costs there.

West and East together generate 61.1% of total company revenue and 69.8% of total profit. These two regions should be the primary focus for retention and growth investment, while Central requires a pricing and discount audit.

## 2. Category Performance

| Category        | Sales     | Profit    | Margin |
|-----------------|-----------|-----------|--------|
| Technology ★    | \$836,154 | \$145,455 | 17.40% |
| Office Supplies | \$719,047 | \$122,491 | 17.04% |
| Furniture       | \$742,000 | \$18,451  | 2.49%  |

Technology has the highest profit margin at 17.40%, narrowly ahead of Office Supplies at 17.04%. Both categories are healthy and comparable. **Furniture's margin is critically low at 2.49%** on sales nearly equal to Technology's (\$742,000 vs \$836,154) — meaning Furniture generates almost the same revenue but 8x less profit.

Drilling into sub-categories, Tables is the single worst performer at -8.56% margin (-\$17,725 loss on \$206,966 sales), followed by Bookcases at -3.02% margin. These two Furniture sub-categories should be reviewed for pricing, supplier cost, or discount policy immediately.

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3. Discount Impact on Profitability

| Discount | Avg Profit | Orders | Status     |
|----------|------------|--------|------------|
| 0%       | +\$66.90   | 4,798  | Profitable |
| 20%      | +\$24.70   | 3,657  | Marginal   |
| 30%      | -\$45.68   | 227    | LOSS       |
| 50%      | -\$310.70  | 66     | LOSS       |
| 70%      | -\$95.87   | 418    | LOSS       |
| 80%      | -\$101.80  | 300    | LOSS       |

Orders with **no discount** average **+\$66.90 profit**. At **30% discount or higher, every single order is loss-making**. There are **1,393 such orders (13.9% of all order lines)**, collectively generating **-\$135,376 in losses**. This is the single largest, fastest-to-fix profitability lever available to management.

4. Customer Analysis

| Segment       | Profit/Cust | Margin  | Customers |
|---------------|-------------|---------|-----------|
| Home Office ★ | \$407.42    | 14.03 % | 148       |
| Corporate     | \$389.74    | 13.03 % | 236       |
| Consumer      | \$327.92    | 11.55 % | 409       |

**Home Office is the most valuable segment** per customer — \$407.42 profit per customer at a 14.03% margin — despite having the fewest customers (148). Consumer has the most customers (409) but the lowest profit-per-customer (\$327.92), pointing to heavier discounting in that segment.

**Top revenue customer Sean Miller (\$23,669 in sales, Home Office segment) is actually UNPROFITABLE at -\$1,787. Five other customers — Cindy Stewart, Grant Thornton, Luke Foster, Sharelle Roach, Henry Goldwyn — each generate net losses exceeding \$2,700. High revenue does not equal high value; these accounts need discount review.**

5. Seasonal Sales Trend

| Quarter        | Sales     | Profit    | Share  |
|----------------|-----------|-----------|--------|
| Q1 (Jan–Mar)   | \$359,682 | \$48,024  | 15.7 % |
| Q2 (Apr–Jun)   | \$445,510 | \$55,285  | 19.4 % |
| Q3 (Jul–Sep)   | \$613,932 | \$72,467  | 26.7 % |
| Q4 (Oct–Dec) ★ | \$878,078 | \$110,622 | 38.2 % |

**A clear seasonal pattern exists.** Q4 is by far the strongest quarter at **\$878,078 in sales (38.2% of annual revenue)**, driven by a steady Sep–Dec ramp (November alone: \$352,461). Q1 is consistently the weakest, starting from a January low of just \$94,925.

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Recommendations for Business Growth

|   |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | <b>Invest Further in West and East</b><br>These two regions generate 61.1% of revenue and 69.8% of profit. Continue marketing and inventory investment here, and use East's superior 13.48% margin discipline as the benchmark for Central and South.                                             |
| 2 | <b>Fix Furniture — Especially Tables and Bookcases</b><br>Furniture earns 2.49% margin on \$742,000 in sales — almost matching Technology's revenue but generating 8x less profit. Audit pricing and supplier costs on Tables (–8.56% margin) and Bookcases (–3.02% margin) immediately.          |
| 3 | <b>Cap All Discounts at 20% — Highest Priority Action</b><br>1,393 orders (13.9%) at 30%+ discount generated a combined –\$135,376 loss. Implement a mandatory manager-approval workflow for any discount above 20%.                                                                              |
| 4 | <b>Build a Home Office Acquisition Campaign</b><br>Home Office delivers the highest profit-per-customer (\$407.42) despite being the smallest segment (148 customers). A targeted acquisition push here offers the best return of any segment.                                                    |
| 5 | <b>Plan Around the Q4 Surge, Review High-Discount Accounts</b><br>Q4 drives 38.2% of annual revenue — build inventory and staffing around this predictable peak. Separately, review accounts like Sean Miller and other negative-profit customers; high revenue does not guarantee profitability. |

Summary — Key Findings at a Glance

| Area                  | Finding              | Key Metric                        |
|-----------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------|
| Top region            | West                 | \$725,458   31.6% of sales        |
| Weakest region        | Central              | 7.92% margin (lowest)             |
| Best category margin  | Technology           | 17.40% margin                     |
| Weakest category      | Furniture            | 2.49% margin                      |
| Discount risk         | 30%+ discount = loss | –\$135,376 total loss             |
| Most valuable segment | Home Office          | \$407.42 profit/customer          |
| Peak quarter          | Q4 (Oct–Dec)         | \$878,078   38.2% of annual sales |

Methodology: Orders and Customers tables joined via SQL INNER JOIN on Customer ID. Source: Superstore Sales Dataset, 9,994 order lines, 5,009 orders, 793 customers. Tools: MySQL, Microsoft Excel, Power BI. | Task 2 Mandatory Deliverable.